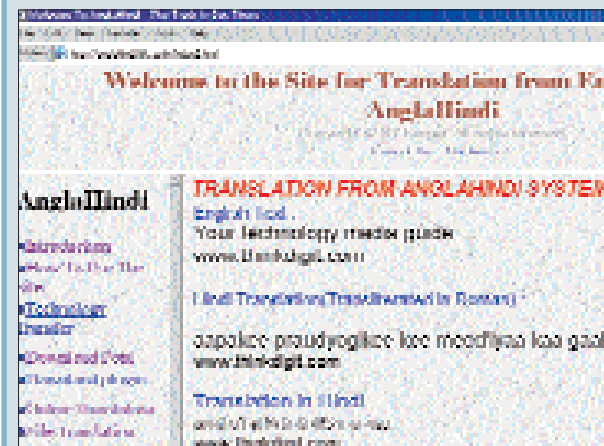


Hamara Bharat mahan!

Some IIT Kanpur students developed a translation service for translating from English into Hindi. The site is called AnglaHindi (<http://anglahindi.iitk.ac.in/index2.html>) and offers a Hindi true type font for download, in case you can't display the Hindi translation properly on your computer. It also has an online editor, which allows you to further edit and tune up obvious translation mistakes by using a pop-up Hindi font keypad. Another exciting feature is the fact that you can upload a plain text file, and have it translated within minutes. It even shows you how many sentences your file has, and shows the real time progress of the translation. Once done, it allows you to view, edit or save the translated file.



AnglaHindi is what IIT Kanpur's attempt at translation is called

pages to searching for sites written in specific languages. It also allows you to view searches, and the Google site itself, in a variety of exotic languages, such as Japanese and Ukrainian. Adding an Indian flavour, it also supports Indian languages such as Hindi, Bengali and Marathi. Google uses Systran's translation technology for its online translation service, available at http://www.google.com/language_tools.



Google offers translation services, a small part of their extensive language services

Using translation Web sites is a snap. All you have to do is navigate to a Web site, say, www.systransoft.com, go to their translation page, and you will see a text input or a URL input box. Enter the text you want translated into the text box, choose the source and destination languages, such as English to Japanese, and click on translate, or press [Enter]. A few seconds later you'll get the translated text. The procedure is similar for Web page translation—just enter the URL of the Web site you want translated, and select the

language you want to see it in. Remember that some languages, such as Japanese, Arabic and Hindi, use a non-English script. You'll have to install the fonts for these scripts before you can view the translated output. Usually the Web site, or your browser, will inform you that a certain site cannot be displayed correctly, and will offer to install the font onto your system. All you do is click Download or OK, depending on the message you get, and view the Web page in that language.

T-Mail (www.t-mail.com) allows you to translate e-mails too. You will need to send a mail to yourself and send a copy to T-mail with the 'Cc:' address in the pre-assigned format. For example, to convert a French e-mail to English, you type **fr-en@T-Mail.com** in the 'Cc:' box and send the e-mail. You receive the translation as a reply. The service, however, is quite painful to use—the return e-mail is sent only after a few hours, and there's gibberish mixed with actual text.

There are also some sites that do translation between two specific languages, such as Ajeeb.com (<http://tarjim.ajeel.com/ajeel/default.asp?lang=1>), which translates from English to Arabic. Ajeeb offers its Tarjim translation tool for free, which you can download and then use to get instantaneous English to Arabic translation. However, you'll have to pay to get an Arabic to English translation.

AltaVista's translation services, is called Babel Fish—taken from the cult novel *The Hitch Hikers Guide to The Galaxy*



Babel Fish: your guide to the translation galaxy

by Douglas Adams. It can be found at <http://babelfish.altavista.com/>, and was the first online translation success story. It uses Systran's translation technologies to offer both text and Web page translation.

FreeTranslation.com (www.freetranslation.com) offers both paid and free translation. You can translate important documents as well, albeit at a price. A click of a button and you can translate anything via human translators. You can get free machine translations as well.



Dictionary.com offers so much more than just word searches

5 cool ways to use Online Translation Services

- 1 E-mail your better half in Japanese, when both of you are at work. If someone sees the e-mail, they won't understand a word. However, this only works for people who work outside of Japan, and who don't have Japanese bosses!
- 2 Conspire to overthrow your boss' evil regime by sending e-mails in German to your colleagues.
- 3 E-mailing e-pals in their native tongue to impress them. Especially if they're cute and plan to visit your country soon.
- 4 Setting up multilingual personal Web sites, to get geographically distributed hits.
- 5 Learn French words and phrases, and use them in classy restaurants, to sound more chic, especially when on a date.